

DEAN VAN NIEKERK

Senior Software Engineer

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Port Elizabeth, South Africa



SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience building full-stack product systems across React, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, real-time APIs, and data-heavy interfaces. Strongest in fast-moving product teams where frontend, backend, architecture, performance, and delivery ownership overlap.

Recent work includes crypto trading tools, live market-data interfaces, custom charting, WebSocket/tRPC systems, Kafka-backed event flows, and production mobile products with 100K+ downloads.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Edge

10/2024 - 06/2026 Remote

<https://x.com/EdgeTrade>

A tech startup specializing in cryptocurrency trading solutions.

- Built React/TypeScript trading, discovery, scanner, charting, wallet/watchlist, and order-update workflows for a crypto trading platform.
- Delivered high-frequency market-data interfaces using Zustand, TanStack Query, virtualized tables/lists, memoized cells, and batched live updates.
- Integrated TradingView with custom OHLC APIs for swap-derived candlestick data, live chart updates, saved layouts, and token/order overlays.
- Implemented real-time discovery and trending-pair flows across Kafka events, compressed tRPC subscriptions, WebSockets, and RisingWave queries.
- Collaborated across frontend, backend, data, and product in a small remote international team.

Team Lead - Senior Software Engineer

Monax Labs

06/2020 - 10/2024 Remote

<https://aspennft.io>

Led engineering delivery for Aspen, a creator-commerce and membership platform with minting, trading, membership management, and white-label storefront tooling.

- Architected product flows across frontend, backend services, shared schemas, and blockchain integrations.
- Built decentralized NFT trading workflows using pre-signed orders and custom 0x smart contracts.
- Delivered white-label storefront tooling for creator-owned collections, custom branding, and minting flows.
- Mentored engineers, reviewed code, and guided technical execution across product priorities.

Senior Software Engineer

Kurtosys Systems

10/2018 - 06/2020 Cape Town, South Africa

Built full-stack fintech tooling for international asset managers including BMO, Federated Hermes, and Bank of America Merrill Lynch.

- Delivered features end-to-end across database migrations, backend services, and frontend interfaces.
- Worked in a regulated financial-services environment with code review, mentoring, and high delivery standards.

SKILLS

Hard Skills

TypeScript	React	Node.js	
PostgreSQL	SQL	tRPC	Git
Docker	GraphQL	Kafka	Vitest

PERSONAL PROJECTS

K53 Study Guide

<https://k53studyguide.online/>

Mobile app that helps learners prepare for their driving learner's test.

- Built and shipped a production mobile learning app with React, Ionic, Capacitor, TypeScript, Redux, Vite, and native Android/iOS integrations.
- Added Firebase/GA4 analytics across landing-page handoff, app engagement, premium prompts, checkout, and purchases.
- Grew and maintained a mobile product with over 100K downloads and a 4.5+ rating on the Play Store.

STRENGTHS

Product Architecture

Turns ambiguous product requirements into maintainable systems across frontend, backend, data, and operational boundaries.

Performance & Reliability

Strong in high-frequency interfaces, real-time updates, query/caching strategy, debugging, and production-quality delivery.

Remote Technical Leadership

Guides technical direction through architecture, code review, mentoring, and practical delivery in distributed teams.